NITMUN XIV

STUDY GUIDE

International Press

"The press is the best instrument for enlightening the mind of man, and improving him as a rational, moral and social being"

ABOUT LITERARY CIRCLE

Literary Circle is the oldest club of NIT Durgapur, which gives the college an extra dimension of creative expression in the midst of technical unilateralism and gives the students of the college an opportunity to transcend the ordinary and mundane. The Literary Circle conducts various events throughout the year: Verve, Literary cum Youth Festival of the college and the biggest of its kind in Eastern India. The Literary Circle successfully pulled off the 20th edition of Verve in 2025. Flagship events in the fest, like the Treasure Hunt, have become a matter of college folklore. The club maintains a blog, The Darkest White, as the culmination of myriad pen strokes from the collective literary expression of the college. The club publishes the yearbook, so each student graduating out of college can reminisce about their days in the college, their hostel life and take with them a part of it. Humans of NIT Durgapur, by The Literary Circle, captures the untold stories, legends, and experiences of individuals, showing our readers how ordinary people can be unique, inspirational and relatable. The TEDx is an initiative where influential speakers are invited in order to realise TED's overall mission to research and discover "Touchstones". TEDxNITDurgapur was co-organised by The Literary Circle and was a confluence of ideas and innovation. The club is known to be highly selective in its admission of new members, with only about 10-15 students inducted out of the entire batch of 900 each year. Great believers of the phrase 'quality over quantity', the members selected every year are the best in the field of expression and creativity. Come, step into the Circle!

ABOUT NITMUN

NITMUN is a forum convened by the members of the Literary Circle for discussion and analysis of global issues. It seeks to bring out motivated delegates from all over the country for a meaningful debate on significant international issues. Currently, in its 14th edition, NITMUN has been extremely successful in providing the perfect experience to each delegate. Over the years, we have entertained more than 2000 delegates totalling all the editions. Delegates arrive from all corners of India for an experience they will never forget.

Overview

Maybe you've always been interested in foreign affairs and international relations but felt like being a delegate representing a nation wasn't for you. Perhaps you have a better knack for expressing your point of view through the written word. Have you found journalism interesting and never found an outlet to try your hand at it?

If this sounds like you, the International Press Corps is for you. Similar to how delegates representing a country engage in open debate in other committees, IPC delegates are journalists who represent news agencies. Our goal is to provide aspiring journalists and budding writers the unique opportunity to put their skills to good use, in the backdrop of the hustle and bustle of a MUN conference.

Today, the IPC stands as the epitome of creative expression of the truth. You, as journalists, have come to the right committee; being in the Press Corps is an experience unlike any other. It is in your hands to question, observe and report every detail during committee. It is you that everyone relies on to capture every moment in NITMUN XII. IPC delegates are encouraged to engage, interact and interview the delegates in their committee and compile their article with quotations from committee proceedings, interviews as well as pictures captured mid-debate. Using intelligent humour is encouraged to boost readership appeal.

Purpose

The IPC is arguably the most interesting committee in NITMUN XII! Instead of being confined to one committee and one political stance, as a Press delegate, you will have the chance to experience debate through the broader lens of the media, while expressing yourself creatively and cogently through writing, art, or photography. During the conference, you will have a platform to showcase your talents – you have the chance to be witty and sarcastic in your illustrations and informal articles, while also being serious and addressing the issues at hand in the opinion pieces and formal articles Remember that the point of a Press Conference is not to attack a particular delegate, but to help arrive at a resolution quicker or make the debate more productive We hope your experience with IPC will be a memorable and educational one.

Research for International Press

You can use the following guidelines for effective research.

You must be adequately prepared to understand the debate.

• Go through the backgrounds for a basic understanding of the agenda and then the documents and links it mentions. The background guide can be obtained from the website of the conference.

• Read about the agenda and various perspectives on it. Aid and form an opinion.

• Understanding the legal, social, cultural, and economic implications of the debate.

• Read about the foreign policy and agenda perspective of nations that you might think will majorly impact the debate.

• Access the quality of research required through various websites of the new agencies and see how the research and content are balanced.

Press Conference

Press conferences are one of the most important aspects of the press. While they take a variety of forms, most often committees will pause debate for 5-15 minutes and allow press members to ask delegates questions about their proposed solutions, specific clauses on draft resolutions, or the committee in general. This is your opportunity to represent your newspaper, hold delegates accountable to their countries' positions, and ask questions that will help you write an article about the committee later on. It is also a chance to display your public speaking skills — the only one you may get in an International press committee!

During the press conference, ask questions! Find a clause in a resolution or directive that your newspaper's readers would want to know more about, and direct your question to either an individual delegate or the committee as a whole. You can also ask about the issues delegates are not addressing, and why they chose not to. Don't be afraid to challenge delegates on their policies' feasibility or alignment with their country's position on an issue — in fact, these are often the best questions. A great question is very memorable, and performing well in press conferences is necessary to be awarded in a press corps committee.

Social Media Updates

Reporters of the International Press will be given Twitter handles for the news agencies they would represent, and it is required of the reporters to post timely updates about the proceedings in committee onto these platforms.
These updates must be formally worded, concise (within the character limit of a tweet), and unbiased, and will serve as a record of their presence and attentiveness in committee.
Any usage of unparliamentary language or visible display of bias through these tweets will result in heavy demarcation and may lead to the disqualification of the delegates.

How to conduct Interviews?

Conducting interviews with individual delegates would let you obtain quotes and information which would help you decorate your articles. The interviews should be scheduled in the same way as press conferences: become familiar with a few delegates in each committee and request their contact information.
Pick delegates who seem knowledgeable about the committee and have the time to speak with you. While delegates who lead their committees are excellent candidates, but they are often preoccupied with other matters and may not have the time to speak with you.
The Press Corps. articles are always clear and concise. Use short paragraphs and omit unnecessary information. Committees often discuss complex topics, which must be explained in an accessible manner to people who are not attending the debate. The articles would help them understand these topics. Define terminology and provide background information on policy proposals and committee topics.

How to write articles

While IPC delegates are required to observe and report council proceedings, they will also be expected to produce enticing articles full of debate analysis at a news angle of your choice within the guidelines and alignment of your news agency's mandate. Delegates must take it upon themselves to remain unbiased in their personal opinions when forming these articles, staying true to their news agency's biases.

Points to keep in mind:

• No personal opinions should be included in your press statement. Opinions of the respective news agency can be used.

• Journalism, not creative writing: This article should be reported strictly in a factual sense. Make sure to keep things interesting with sound conduct in language. However, avoid overusing too many adjectives, flowery words, and euphemisms.

• Always verify the details of your article and crosscheck the facts and statistics provided by you in your report.

• Delegates are encouraged to bring their research notes

Style Guide

There are certain rules that every IP member must adhere to when writing articles and these are compiled in the style guide.

Abbreviations:

No periods should be used in separate letters of an abbreviated organisation or agency. Only standard acronyms and approved abbreviations should be used. If questions arise, feel free to ask any of the editors. Before using an acronym, first, the full form should be mentioned once within brackets. Example: United Nations (UN). Some example abbreviations include: NITMUN, UNGA, UK, UN, US, and DPRK.

Apostrophes:

This punctuation mark will only be used to indicate possessive nouns or secondary quotations. Apostrophes are never used to indicate plurals. Currency: Dollar values are displayed with the appropriate currency symbol. Values on orders at or greater than one million are summarized, for example, $54,000, $135,000 or $214 million. Indian Rupees shall be written as INR and not Rs.

Capitalization:

Nowhere shall anything but Abbreviations be capitalised.

Boldface text:

There is no situation in which boldface should be used in an article. Headlines and article titles may be bolded by the Publisher. Books and print sources. Names of all books and print sources should be capitalised and italicised, such as the newsletter, New York Times and The Economist.

Developing nations:

Within the international community, the use of the term “third world” is actively discouraged. No nation will be referred to as “Third World.“

Diplomatic courtesy:

While Reporters are encouraged to faithfully report on the statements of representatives within each NITMUN simulation, no quotation should violate the dictates of diplomatic courtesy.

All articles, editorials, letters, press releases and personals to be included in the newsletter will be carefully edited to ensure that all content remains courteous to all participants at NITMUN. If a Reporter feels that a quotation by a representative is discourteous, the representative should be courageous enough to rephrase the statement in a more courteous fashion or risk having it omitted from the Reporter's article.

Hyphenation:

Hyphens should only be applied according to American English grammar. If questions arise, consult the Editors. Examples of typically hyphenated prefixes include non-, sub- and ex-. Some compound words are hyphenated as well, such as socio-political.

Member States. In print, references to United Nations "Member States "should be initially capitalised

National references:

When referring to any UN Member State or Observer, standard UN country names should be used. These names match those with which each nation signed the UN Charter. For example, Libya is recognized by the UN as "Libyan Arab Jamahiriya."

Numerals:

Any numeral ten or less should be spelt out in English. Numerals over tenure reported using standard Arabic numerals, such as 2018. Numerals with five or more digits should include commas. Fractions and decimal numbers should be reported as decimal numerals or percentages, such as 0.5 or 50%(rather than "1/2"). Roman numerals are used only when referring to a source which was originally designated using Roman numerals, such as Chapter VII of the UN Charter (articles of the UN Charter are written as "Article 7"). Ordinal numerals are spelt out within the text of an article, such as the First Committee of the General Assembly. In article headings or titles, the Publisher may choose to use ordinal abbreviations, such as 1st Committee.

Percentages:

Percent symbols will be used to report percentages, for example, 35.8%.

Quotation marks:

As per standard English grammar, punctuation after quotation must always be included inside the closing quotation mark.

Quotations:

All quoted statements within articles should be incorporated grammatically into the sentence being written. Additional capitalization should be avoided. If only part of a sentence is being used in a quotation, an ellipsis should be used to indicate the omitted portions of the statement. If, within a quotation, the speaker uses an abbreviation or reference which would be unclear to the reader, the journalist may interject a clarification within brackets (i.e.:[...]). This indicates that the bracketed information is not a direct quotation; rather it is a clarification on the part of the author.

Spacing:

One space is used to separate words, as well as following commas, semicolons, colons and periods. Since the newsletter is published in a variable-width font, two spaces between sentences will not be necessary.

Spelling:

Reporters should be sure to spell-check all articles before the editorial deadline. This will greatly assist the Editor.

Titles:

The categories of titles to be used include: • Standard professional titles: Periods will be used on abbreviated titles, such as Mr., Ms., Amb., Dr., Pres.

UN Titles:

These titles will not be abbreviated. UN and MCGS MUN official titles include Secretary-General, Under-Secretary-General, Director-General, Assistant Secretary General, and Deputy Secretary-General. Secretary-General shall never be abbreviated as Sec Gen.

Journalism can be done by everyone, even without any special skills. Unlike other communities of NITMUN, IP is completely different and you can have the most amazing experience of interacting with every committee simultaneously. Restrictions are for the world not for the press. You are free to express and explore yourself as a journalist or reporter, and by preparing you for this role we expect you to have the best NITMUN ever!

You are the press, uncover the truth to the world!

Portfolio

AIPPM

- HINDUSTAN TIMES
- TIMES OF INDIA
- THE HINDU

UNGA

- REUTERS
- ASSOCIATED PRESS
- UNITED PRESS INTERNATIONAL

UNHRC

- REUTERS
- ASSOCIATED PRESS
- UNITED PRESS INTERNATIONAL